



# MarkingForge

Preset packs - ready-made dials for modelling, animation, look-dev and archviz

3DS MAX 2027 · VERSION 1.0.4

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Four sets of dials for one kind of work each. A pack replaces only the dials it names and leaves the rest of your layout as it is. Load one, try it for a day, keep what works.

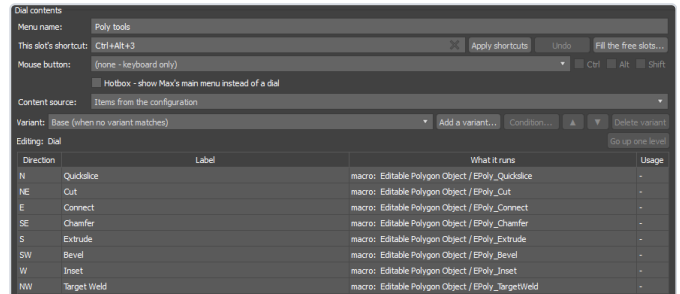
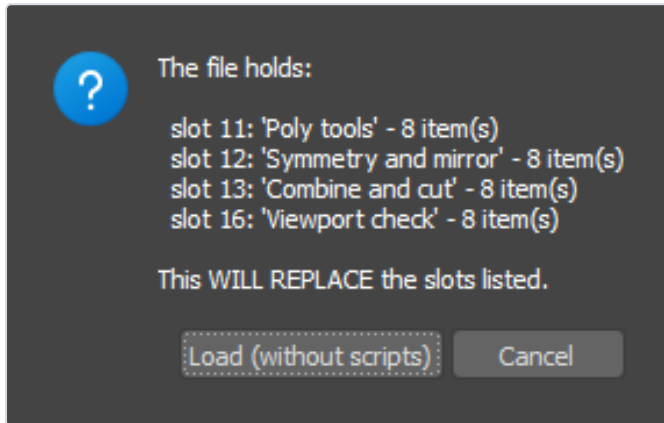
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# Loading a pack

- 1 Open **MarkingForge > Menu editor...**
- 2 Press **Load preset...** at the bottom and open a file from the **Presets** folder of the download.
- 3 The editor lists the dials the pack replaces - read it and press **Load (without scripts)**; the packs have none.
- 4 Look at the dials in the editor, then press **Save**. The dials change at once - no restart.



After loading: dial 11 is now Poly tools.

Before loading: the dials the Modelling pack will replace.

**Want your dials back?** Before saving: **Reload from file** throws the pack away. After saving: **Load default dials...** (tick *Replace the slots that already have a menu as well*) restores the built-in layout - or keep a copy of your own with **Save preset...** before trying a pack.

The packs contain only 3ds Max commands - no scripts - so nothing is removed when they load, and every command was checked against a stock 2027 release of 3ds Max.

## The packs at a glance

| Pack                                                 | For                                                                                                                                                                                           | Replaces                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Modelling</b><br>MarkingForge_Pack_Modelling.json | Hard-surface and poly modelling: the poly tools on one key whatever the sub-object level, symmetry and mirror tools, combining and cutting, and a viewport check dial.                        | Poly tools (Ctrl+Alt+3, was: Show and hide), Symmetry and mirror (Ctrl+Alt+4, was: Viewports), Combine and cut (Ctrl+Alt+5, was: Viewport display), Viewport check (Ctrl+Alt+8, was: Render) |
| <b>Animation</b><br>MarkingForge_Pack_Animation.json | Keyframing: transform with the animation coordinate systems, every key command, playback and time, curves, tangents and layers - with Track View commands when the cursor is over Track View. | Animate transform (Ctrl+Alt+1, was: Transform), Keys (Ctrl+Alt+4, was: Viewports), Playback and time (Ctrl+Alt+8, was: Render), Curves and layers (Shift+Alt+2, was: Animation)              |
| <b>LookDev</b><br>MarkingForge_Pack_LookDev.json     | Look development: viewport shading and overrides, light display and shadows, camera controls.                                                                                                 | Shading (Ctrl+Alt+5, was: Viewport display), Lights (Shift+Alt+7, was: Tools and setup), Cameras (Shift+Alt+8, was: Lights and cameras)                                                      |

**Archviz****MarkingForge\_Pack\_Archviz.json**

Architectural visualisation and layout:  
placing, arraying and aligning, snaps,  
layers and groups, references and files.

Place and array (Ctrl+Alt+1, was:  
Transform), Snaps (Ctrl+Alt+6, was:  
Snaps and grid), Layers and groups  
(Shift+Alt+3, was: Scene), References  
and files (Shift+Alt+4, was: File)

# Modelling pack

Hard-surface and poly modelling: the poly tools on one key whatever the sub-object level, symmetry and mirror tools, combining and cutting, and a viewport check dial.

File: Presets\MarkingForge\_Pack\_Modelling.json

## Ctrl+Alt+3 Poly tools

dial 11 - replaces Show and hide

|                   |                 |               |
|-------------------|-----------------|---------------|
| NW<br>Target Weld | N<br>Quickslice | NE<br>Cut     |
| W<br>Inset        | Poly tools      | E<br>Connect  |
| SW<br>Bevel       | S<br>Extrude    | SE<br>Chamfer |

List under the dial: Swift Loop · Remove Loop · Flow Connect · Distance Connect · Make planar · Tessellate · Hinge · Outline

## Ctrl+Alt+4 Symmetry and mirror

dial 12 - replaces Viewports

|                |                     |                      |
|----------------|---------------------|----------------------|
| NW<br>+ Mirror | N<br>+ Symmetry     | NE<br>Symmetry tools |
| W<br>- to +    | Symmetry and mirror | E<br>+ to -          |
| SW<br>Copy     | S<br>Flip           | SE<br>Paste          |

List under the dial: Mirror element X · Mirror element Y · Mirror element Z · Symmetry select X · Mirror (object)...

## Ctrl+Alt+5 Combine and cut

dial 13 - replaces Viewport display

|                   |                     |                  |
|-------------------|---------------------|------------------|
| NW<br>+ Cap Holes | N<br>ProCutter      | NE<br>ShapeMerge |
| W<br>+ Welder     | Combine and cut     | E<br>Connect     |
| SW<br>Snapshot... | S<br>Collapse stack | SE<br>Attach     |

List under the dial: Detach · + Vertex Weld · + Smart Bevel · + Chamfer

## Ctrl+Alt+8 Viewport check

dial 16 - replaces Render

|                         |                  |                   |
|-------------------------|------------------|-------------------|
| NW<br>Zoom selected     | N<br>Edged faces | NE<br>See-through |
| W<br>Wireframe / shaded | Viewport check   | E<br>Statistics   |
| SW<br>Backface cull     | S<br>Isolate     | SE<br>Edges only  |

List under the dial: Clay · Realistic with maps · Default shading · Wireframe · Vertex ticks

# Animation pack

Keyframing: transform with the animation coordinate systems, every key command, playback and time, curves, tangents and layers - with Track View commands when the cursor is over Track View.

File: Presets\MarkingForge\_Pack\_Animation.json

## Ctrl+Alt+1 Animate transform

dial 9 - replaces Transform

|                             |                              |                             |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Coords: world  | <b>N</b><br>Move             | <b>NE</b><br>Rotate         |
| <b>W</b><br>Coords: local   | <b>Animate transform</b>     | <b>E</b><br>Scale           |
| <b>SW</b><br>Coords: parent | <b>S</b><br>Freeze transform | <b>SE</b><br>Coords: gimbal |

**List under the dial:** Freeze position · Freeze rotation · Link · Unlink · Select parent · Select child

## Ctrl+Alt+4 Keys

dial 12 - replaces Viewports

|                           |                      |                           |
|---------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Key mode     | <b>N</b><br>Key all  | <b>NE</b><br>Key position |
| <b>W</b><br>Auto Key      | <b>Keys</b>          | <b>E</b><br>Key rotation  |
| <b>SW</b><br>Set Key mode | <b>S</b><br>Set keys | <b>SE</b><br>Key scale    |

**List under the dial:** Key pos, rot, scale · Set key selected · Clear Set Key buffer · Create key

## Ctrl+Alt+8 Playback and time

dial 16 - replaces Render

|                            |                          |                                    |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Ghosting      | <b>N</b><br>Play         | <b>NE</b><br>Next frame            |
| <b>W</b><br>Previous frame | <b>Playback and time</b> | <b>E</b><br>Go to end              |
| <b>SW</b><br>Go to start   | <b>S</b><br>Motion paths | <b>SE</b><br>Time configuration... |

**List under the dial:** SMPTE / frames · Show key times

## Shift+Alt+2 Curves and layers

dial 18 - replaces Animation

|                                      |                                   |                                      |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Merge animation...      | <b>N</b><br>Track View            | <b>NE</b><br>Animation layers...     |
| <b>W</b><br>Default tangent: stepped | <b>Curves and layers</b>          | <b>E</b><br>Default tangent: linear  |
| <b>SW</b><br>Reaction manager...     | <b>S</b><br>Default tangent: auto | <b>SE</b><br>Default tangent: smooth |

**List under the dial:** Default tangent: spline · Default tangent: fast · Default tangent: slow · Save animation... · Load animation...

Changes to **Track View** when cursor over Track View.

# LookDev pack

Look development: viewport shading and overrides, light display and shadows, camera controls.

File: `Presets\MarkingForge_Pack_LookDev.json`

## Ctrl+Alt+5 Shading

dial 13 - replaces Viewport display

|                          |                                 |                                 |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Fast shader | <b>N</b><br>Realistic with maps | <b>NE</b><br>Realistic, no maps |
| <b>W</b><br>Override off | <b>Shading</b>                  | <b>E</b><br>Shaded with maps    |
| <b>SW</b><br>Clay        | <b>S</b><br>Default shading     | <b>SE</b><br>UV checker         |

**List under the dial:** Override: render setting · Lit wireframes · Hidden line · Transparency: best · Default / scene lights

## Shift+Alt+7 Lights

dial 23 - replaces Tools and setup

|                                   |                            |                                    |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Lock lights          | <b>N</b><br>Light Explorer | <b>NE</b><br>Shadows on            |
| <b>W</b><br>Light view            | <b>Lights</b>              | <b>E</b><br>Default / scene lights |
| <b>SW</b><br>Only selected lights | <b>S</b><br>Hide lights    | <b>SE</b><br>Shadows off           |

**List under the dial:** Unlock lights · Select lighting lights · Select shadow lights · Add default lights · Environment...

## Shift+Alt+8 Cameras

dial 24 - replaces Lights and cameras

|                            |                          |                                   |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Roll          | <b>N</b><br>Camera view  | <b>NE</b><br>Match camera to view |
| <b>W</b><br>Dolly          | <b>Cameras</b>           | <b>E</b><br>Safe frames           |
| <b>SW</b><br>Field of view | <b>S</b><br>Hide cameras | <b>SE</b><br>Align camera         |

**List under the dial:** Truck · Pan camera · Select camera · Select target · Viewport camera 1 · More cameras...

# Archviz pack

Architectural visualisation and layout: placing, arraying and aligning, snaps, layers and groups, references and files.

File: Presets\MarkingForge\_Pack\_Archviz.json

## Ctrl+Alt+1 Place and array

dial 9 - replaces Transform

|                 |                  |                          |
|-----------------|------------------|--------------------------|
| NW<br>Align...  | N<br>Place       | NE<br>Array...           |
| W<br>Clone      | Place and array  | E<br>Spacing tool...     |
| SW<br>Mirror... | S<br>Snapshot... | SE<br>Clone and align... |

**List under the dial:** Quick align · Normal align... · Type-in... · + Array modifier

## Ctrl+Alt+6 Snaps

dial 14 - replaces Snaps and grid

|                        |                     |                        |
|------------------------|---------------------|------------------------|
| NW<br>AutoGrid         | N<br>Snaps          | NE<br>Angle snap       |
| W<br>Cycle snap type   | Snaps               | E<br>Percent snap      |
| SW<br>Axis constraints | S<br>Snap to frozen | SE<br>Snap settings... |

**List under the dial:** Spinner snap · Align grid to view · Hide grids · Grid top · Grid front

## Shift+Alt+3 Layers and groups

dial 19 - replaces Scene

|                      |                   |                     |
|----------------------|-------------------|---------------------|
| NW<br>Scene Explorer | N<br>New layer    | NE<br>Add to layer  |
| W<br>Layer Explorer  | Layers and groups | E<br>Select layer   |
| SW<br>Freeze layer   | S<br>Hide layer   | SE<br>Isolate layer |

**List under the dial:** Group · Ungroup · Open group · Close group · Attach to group · Detach from group  
Changes to **Scene Explorer** when cursor over the Scene Explorer.

## Shift+Alt+4 References and files

dial 20 - replaces File

|                       |                      |                       |
|-----------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|
| NW<br>Summary info... | N<br>XRef scene...   | NE<br>XRef objects... |
| W<br>Save incremental | References and files | E<br>Merge...         |
| SW<br>Archive...      | S<br>Import...       | SE<br>Replace...      |

**List under the dial:** Save · Export... · Export selected... · Save selected... · Project paths...

# Make your own pack

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- 1 Arrange the dials you want to share in the editor.
- 2 **Save preset...** writes your layout to one file - without usage data or paths.
- 3 To share only some dials, remove the others from the file in a text editor: a preset replaces exactly the dials it holds (keys `"1"` to `"24"` under `"menus"`).
- 4 Scripts in a preset are removed when somebody else loads it, unless they choose **Load WITH the scripts** - wherever they sit: directions, list rows, the tap item, submenus and variants. Prefer 3ds Max commands for anything you share.

# Support, bug reports and feature requests

|        |                                                                                                                    |
|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ISSUES | <a href="https://github.com/looki666/MarkingForge/issues">github.com/looki666/MarkingForge/issues</a>              |
| E-MAIL | <a href="mailto:forgeplugins@gmail.com">forgeplugins@gmail.com</a>                                                 |
| WEB    | <a href="https://forgeplugins.tech">https://forgeplugins.tech</a> (forgeplugins.tech - more plugins by the author) |

**Bug reports and feature requests** are best opened as issues on GitHub - the forms there ask for exactly what is needed, and you can follow the fix. Questions, and anything you would rather not post publicly (licence, purchase), go to the e-mail address. Every message is read.

## Reporting a bug

- 1 In 3ds Max choose **MarkingForge > Report a bug...** - it copies your 3ds Max version, MarkingForge version, configuration summary and start-up log to the clipboard. It works even when the plugin did not load.
- 2 Open [github.com/looki666/MarkingForge/issues](https://github.com/looki666/MarkingForge/issues) and pick **Bug report** - or answer **Yes** in the dialog to write an e-mail to [forgeplugins@gmail.com](mailto:forgeplugins@gmail.com) instead.
- 3 Say what you did, what you expected and what happened instead, then paste the details with **Ctrl+V**.
- 4 Add a screenshot if you can. When the problem is in one dial, attach a preset of it (editor > **Save preset...**).

## Suggesting a feature

Open an issue with the **Feature request** form, choose **MarkingForge > Suggest a feature...**, or simply write. Describe what you would like to do and how you do it today - a concrete example from your work says more than a list of wishes. Ideas for new built-in dials, commands and options are all welcome.

Nothing is sent by the plugin itself: the details go to the clipboard and your own e-mail program, so you see everything that leaves your computer. MarkingForge has no network access.